

Oakwood Primary School

ParentPay User Guide

Oakwood Lane, Millbrook, MB12 4ST

Tel: 01234 567890 | Email: office@oakwood-primary.sch.uk

What is ParentPay?

ParentPay is our online payment system that allows you to pay for school meals, trips, clubs, and other activities quickly and securely from your computer, tablet, or smartphone.

Benefits of using ParentPay: -  No need to send cash to school -  View your payment history at any time -  Receive automatic email receipts -  Set up payment reminders -  Manage multiple children from one account

Getting Started

First Time Setup

1. **Check your email** - You will receive an activation letter from the school office containing:

- Your unique activation username
- Your activation password
- A link to activate your account

2. **Activate your account** within 30 days:

- Go to www.parentpay.com
- Click "Activate an account"
- Enter your activation username and password
- Create your own username and password
- Add your email address and mobile number

3. **Link additional children** (if applicable):

- Once logged in, click "Add a child"
- Enter the activation details from their letter

If You've Lost Your Activation Letter

Contact the school office and we'll send you a new one via email or post. Please allow 24 hours for us to generate new login details.

What Can You Pay For?

School Meals (KS2 Only)

- **Cost:** £2.50 per meal
- **Ordering deadline:** Wednesday for the following week
- **How it works:**
 - Log in to ParentPay
 - Click "School Meals"
 - Select the days you want hot meals
 - Payment is taken immediately
- **Note:** Reception, Year 1, and Year 2 receive free school meals and don't need to order via ParentPay

After-School Clubs

- **Cost:** £3 per session (some clubs are free)
- **Booking period:** At the start of each term
- **How it works:**
 - Bookings open at specific times (announced in newsletters)
 - Select the club and number of sessions
 - Payment charged per half-term block

School Trips

- **Cost:** Varies by trip
- **How it works:**
 - A letter will be sent home about upcoming trips
 - Trip payment items will appear on your ParentPay account
 - Deadline for payment will be clearly stated
 - **Important:** Trips cannot go ahead if we don't have enough participants or funding

Other Items You Can Pay For:

- Book bags and water bottles
 - Replacement items (ties, PE kit)
 - Breakfast Club and After-School Club
 - School photographs
 - PTA fundraising events
 - Music lessons (if applicable)
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How to Make a Payment

1. **Log in** to www.parentpay.com with your username and password
 2. **Select your child** (if you have more than one)
 3. **Click on the item** you want to pay for
 4. **Enter the amount** (pre-filled for most items)
 5. **Click "Pay"** and complete the payment using:
 - Debit card
 - Credit card
 - Or add funds to your ParentPay account first
 6. **You'll receive a confirmation email** with a receipt
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Managing Your Account

Viewing Payment History

- Click "Payment history" from your dashboard
- Filter by date, child, or payment type
- Download receipts as PDFs

Setting Up Payment Reminders

- Go to "Account settings"
- Turn on email reminders for low balances or deadlines

Adding Funds to Your Account

Some parents prefer to add funds to their ParentPay account balance and then allocate them to different items. This can be done in the "Add funds" section.

Updating Contact Details

- Keep your email address and phone number up to date
 - Go to "Your account" → "Edit details"
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Frequently Asked Questions

Do I have to use ParentPay?

We strongly encourage all parents to use ParentPay as it makes administration easier for the school office. However, if you cannot use ParentPay for any reason, please speak to Mrs. Davies in the office about alternative arrangements.

Is ParentPay secure?

Yes. ParentPay is PCI DSS Level 1 compliant (the highest level of security). Your card details are never stored on school systems.

Can I use PayPal or other payment methods?

Currently, ParentPay only accepts debit and credit cards (Visa, Mastercard, Maestro). We cannot accept PayPal, Apple Pay, or other methods.

What if I can't afford to pay for something?

Please speak to Mrs. Mitchell or Mrs. Davies in confidence. We never want cost to be a barrier to participation. There may be funding available to help.

My child has a free school meal - do I still need ParentPay?

Yes, you'll still use ParentPay for clubs, trips, and other items. Your child's free meal entitlement is automatically applied.

Can I get a refund?

- **School meals:** Refunds only for absence due to illness (call the office) - **Trips:** Refunds depend on circumstances - speak to the office - **Clubs:** Partial refunds for long-term illness with doctor's note

I forgot my password. What do I do?

Click "Forgotten password?" on the ParentPay login page and follow the instructions. You'll receive a reset link by email.

The website isn't working. What should I do?

- First, try a different web browser or device - Clear your browser cache and cookies - Contact ParentPay support: 02476 994 870 (8am-6pm weekdays) - Or email: parentpay@parentpay.com

Can grandparents or other family members use my account?

You can share your login details if you wish, but please keep them secure. Only one person can be logged in at a time.

Payment Deadlines

Please note these important deadlines:

Item	Deadline
School meals	Wednesday for the following week
After-school clubs	As announced (usually Friday before term starts)
School trips	Date specified on trip letter (usually 2 weeks before trip)
Breakfast/After-school club	Payment in advance or same day by 8:30am

Late payments may result in: - School meals: Child provided with a packed lunch alternative (no hot meal) - Clubs: Place given to another child on the waiting list - Trips: Place cannot be guaranteed

Need Help?

Technical Issues with ParentPay

ParentPay Customer Services:

Phone: 02476 994 870 (Monday-Friday, 8am-6pm)

Email: parentpay@parentpay.com

Questions About School Payments

Oakwood School Office:

Phone: 01234 567890

Email: office@oakwood-primary.sch.uk

Ask for Mrs. Davies (Office Manager)

Office hours: Monday-Friday, 8:30am - 4:00pm (term time)

Top Tips for Using ParentPay

1.  **Check your account regularly** - especially on Mondays for the week ahead
 2.  **Enable email notifications** - so you don't miss payment deadlines
 3.  **Keep contact details updated** - so we can reach you about payment issues
 4.  **Set calendar reminders** - for school meal ordering (every Wednesday!)
 5.  **Check for new items weekly** - especially at the start of term when trips are announced
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Oakwood Educational Academy

Growing Together, Learning Forever

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